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PHOTO BY **GETTY IMAGES**

south-west monsoon causes a large collection of plankton to get caught in the funnel-like reef around the eastern side of the Maldivian atolls, and this attracts hundreds of manta rays and whale sharks to come and feed on the coral reefs. Snorkel or dive with these gentle giants. Hotels such as Four Seasons and Dusit Thani offer special packages during manta season.

► **Amazon Adventure**

Do you have it in you to survive in the Amazon forests? Find out, by enrolling yourself in a jungle sur-

vival course. The two-week course takes you to the depths of Guyana's rainforest where a team of experts will guide you on what it takes to survive in the wild. Everything from skills needed to find water, light a fire without matches, source food and create a shelter will be taught to you. But after your week-long training, you will be dropped in a new area of the jungle with only a machete, a bow and arrow and a few supplies, to fend for yourself for a few days. With nothing else but the clothes on your back, test your newfound survival skills in an exhilarating real-world situation. UK-based

travel company The Wild Tales offers packages for \$2,990-3,090.

► **The Tequila Train**

All aboard the Tequila train. The Jose Cuervo Express is an old-fashioned train complete with luxury wagons that travels from the city of Guadalajara in western Mexico to the town of Tequila, which the Mexican tourism department has called Pueblo Magico (or Magic Town). Step into the vintage vehicle, and you'll be transported back in time for a glamorous day of cocktails by train car. Take a